

`PascalCase`, named for its use in the Pascal programming language, is similar to `camelCase` but capitalizes the first word as well.

Casing is a code formatting issue and we cover it in Chapter 3. The most common styles are `snake_case` and `camelCase`. Either is fine to use as long as your project consistently uses one or the other, not both.

PEP 8's Naming Conventions

The PEP 8 document introduced in Chapter 3 has some recommendations for Python naming conventions:

- All letters should be ASCII letters—that is, uppercase and lowercase English letters that don't have accent marks.
- Modules should have short, all lowercase names.
- Class names should be written in `PascalCase`.
- Constant variables should be written in uppercase `SNAKE_CASE`.
- Function, method, and variable names should be written in lowercase `snake_case`.
- The first argument for methods should always be named `self` in lowercase.
- The first argument for class methods should always be named `cls` in lowercase.
- Private attributes in classes should always begin with an underscore (`_`).
- Public attributes in classes should never begin with an underscore (`_`).

You can bend or break these rules as required. For example, although English is the dominant language in programming, you can use letter characters in any language as identifiers: `コンピューター = 'laptop'` is syntactically valid Python code. As you can see in this book, my preference for variable names goes against PEP 8, because I use `camelCase` rather than `snake_case`. PEP 8 contains a reminder that a programmer doesn't need to